CHESS 2026/2027 Grades 6-8 Course Descriptions

Drama (grades 4 – 12); 8:15

During this two-semester course, students will learn how to put on a theatrical performance. Each week we will learn various acting skills and terms. These include how to project our voices, understanding how and when to move on stage, becoming your character, and many other things! We will use theatrical games and exercises to help us learn these things - all leading up to our performance in the spring! Students will also learn that all media, including stage performances, should be for the glory of God. Our play will give us plenty of opportunities to talk about the gospel and growing in Godly maturity.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: good reading skills
- Texts (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): none
- Homework: two to three hours per week. Students should expect to commit to weekly memorization/working on lines once assigned.
- Internet needed for homework: Some internet use may be needed.
- Material fee: $10

Physical Science; 8:15

In this two-semester course, we will introduce students to basic chemistry, physics, and earth science. This course is intended to help ease the transition between elementary science courses and high school science courses. There will be reading and homework assignments each week. Labs will be during regular class periods.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisite: none
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): Apologia Exploring Creation with Physical Science, 2nd edition, ISBN: 193201277X; ISBN-13: 978-1932012774
  - Colorado Heritage has a limited number of this textbook available for a donation. Please contact the office at office@coloradoheritage.org for details.
- Homework: 2 - 4 hours/week
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Lab/Material fee: none

Elementary Choir (grades K-8); 9:15

In this two-semester course, we will be learning themed or seasonal music from a variety of genres for performance each semester. We focus on vocal technique, especially learning how to control pitch and dynamics. Students are required to attend the end-of-semester performance which is generally scheduled for the final week of each semester. The specific date is scheduled by the beginning of each semester.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters plus a dress rehearsal and one performance each semester. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: none
- Texts (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): None. Music will be provided by the teacher.
- Homework: none
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Material fee: none

JH/HS Art: Story/Illustration Art; 10:15

The focus of this class will be to learn consistent style and layout. When doing illustrations and telling a story with art, themes, color and style are important. The purpose of this class will be to work through the process of storytelling in pictures and art. God has made the world very delightful to the eyes. With good stories, we want to pair good art with them to capture true balance.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: none
- Texts: none
- Homework: two to four hours per homework project
- Internet needed for homework: It may be helpful.
- Material fee: $10

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Junior High Literature; 10:15

John Bunyan's immortal classic, *Christiana* (Pilgrim's Progress, part 2), will be our text during the fall semester. According to the editor, Jim Pappas, "While Christiana and her boys traverse the same narrow path as did her husband, Christian, the experiences, conversations, lesson and characters met along the way are mostly new." Bunyan's inimitable style is an education in itself, and this book is a masterpiece of solid theology mixed with fine storytelling. This two-semester course will help to prepare students for the more rigorous requirements of high school literature and develop their vocabulary to an amazing extent, along with teaching them to appreciate older literature with richer content and more archaic words than what they normally read.

Course Detail

- 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisite: Students must be in 5th-8th grade. This course is designed for students with intermediate levels in reading and writing, but I am willing to work with students where they are.
- Text: The teacher will purchase the books for each student. Please do not purchase your own copies. There is a $45 book fee for this class (see below); this fee covers the purchase of ALL the books listed in the description above that will be used during the entire school year. Students do not need to purchase any other books for this class, and there are no additional material fees.
  - First semester text is *Christiana* by John Bunyan.
  - Second semester texts will be both *The* B*ark of the Bog Owl*, by Jonathan Rogers and *The Bronze Bow,* by Elizabeth George Speare.
- Homework: 30-35 pages of reading per week on average. Frequent quizzes are given, and several short essays are assigned to help students grow in their ability to analyze the text and articulate their ideas and make logical arguments.
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Book fee: $45 (This fee covers the cost of all the books used during the full year of this course.)

Structure & Style; 11:15

In this two-semester course, students will review/ learn the mechanics of writing (punctuation, parts of speech, paragraphs), writing structure, and elements of style using the "Excellence in Writing" program. Compositions will include plenty of paragraphs, not-so-boring book reports, be-your-own-movie-critic, etc.

Course Detail

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: Basic writing and reading skills
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): none
- Homework (How many hours per week?): 2-3 hours
- Internet needed for homework: No
- Material fee: $5

Cooking Class; 11:15

Geared for junior high boys and girls (offered to high school students as well) and back by popular demand, this is a less intensive two-semester cooking class that meets only once a week. Moms, would you like your boys and girls to know how to make chili and beef stew from scratch? How about fresh sourdough bread and pumpkin and apple pie? Once again, we will use the cookbook *Salt, Fat, Acid, Heat*, by Samin Nosrat as our text. In her hands-on book, Nosrat explains the principles behind cooking, and with stories and humor, describes how to master these four elements and be liberated from to-the-letter recipes and precise shopping lists into a skillful cook that can improvise with ingredients on hand. The goal for this class is to help your student to learn skills that will enable him or her to thrive in the kitchen—even feel at home there, creating delicious food to bless and serve the family.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (H).
- Prerequisite: none
- Texts (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): *Salt, Fat, Acid, Heat*, by Samin Nosrat
- Homework: occasional at-home projects and weekly reading and quizzes
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Material fee: $50. This equals about 1.80/week for the entire school year.

Speech; 1:15

This two-semester class will help you to utilize the written and spoken tools of the English language with the goal of helping you communicate. One way we will do this is work on writing clear sentences with correct punctuation. Another way will be to work on identifying and avoiding logical fallacies in our conversation and writing, and finally, to speak clearly and with purpose, conveying solid ideas confidently while in front of others. To be successful in this class, students should come to class prepared to interact with one another. This is a hands-on class and will require a teachable spirit. Students must be willing to get up front and talk—sometimes giving a prepared speech, sometimes an impromptu speech. Students will need to keep a loose-leaf notebook for the class—every handout must be displayed in this notebook, along with quizzes, tests, and speeches. This notebook will be graded at the end of class. A loose-leaf notebook with notebook paper and page protectors is required! Many handouts will be given and must be displayed in the page protector directly in the class notebook.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: a willingness to stand before the class and speak
- Materials required (supplied by the family): a loose-leaf notebook with notebook paper and page protectors
- Texts (sourced and purchased by family): *Sound Speech** by BJU Press ISBN 978-60682-236-4. *Colorado Heritage has a limited quantity of this textbook available for a donation. Please contact the office at office@coloradoheritage.org for details.
- Homework: one to two hours per week: weekly reading and speech preparation assigned; studying for quizzes, tests
- Internet needed for homework: possibly, but rarely
- Material fee: none

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Colorado History; 1:15

In this two-semester class, students will go on a journey through Colorado's history! We will meet the Native Americans who first lived in the area and who continue into the modern day. We'll also stop for a little bit to look into the history of Greeley! This course will allow students to tackle harder interpretive issues such as colonialism and the Meeker Incident. This course will emphasize using the Bible and the facts of the event as a tool for understanding these issues. In the fall semester, we will work on a first-person presentation - resulting in the students presenting themselves as a person from history at the CHESS fall open house!

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters; Class meets one day a week (H).
- Prerequisite: None
- Textbook (sourced and purchased by family): **TBD**
- Homework: 1-2 hours/week (reading textbook material, working though projects)
- Internet needed for homework: Yes (for research)
- Material fee: none

Bible Class (grades 6-8); 1:15

In this two-semester class, we will mainly be studying the book of John, focusing particularly on the person and work of Christ as expressed in the Gospel. The objective of this class is to learn who Jesus is, so that your child may grow in their faith and personal walk with the Lord. The students will have the opportunity to do an in-depth study of John, along with receiving personal life applications. Students may expect to read one to two chapters a week, along with weekly memory verses and other activities.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: None
- Texts: (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): ESV (English Standard Version) Bible (one that can be marked in)
- Homework: 1 to 3 hours per week
- Internet needed for homework: yes
- Material fee: $5

Advanced Chamber Ensemble (grades 6-12), 2:15

In this two-semester class, we will learn a combination of standard chamber music and hymn arrangements to perform in conjunction with the chorale performance. Material is selected seasonally or topically. Students are required to attend the end-of-semester performance, which is usually scheduled for the last week of each semester. We announce the specific dates by the beginning of each semester.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semester. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: Students must be able to play an orchestral instrument, be able to read music, and play at least at an advanced beginner level (approx. Suzuki, level 3).
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): None. Music will be provided by the teacher.
- Homework: None required, although practicing at home may be beneficial for some students.
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Material fee: none

Elementary Physical Education (grades 3-8); 2:15

This two-semester course is designed to encourage teamwork, hand-eye coordination, and exercise. The goal in this class is to incorporate loving one another, humility, and the strengthening of our bodies, minds, and spirits through the teachings in scripture - all while having fun.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Pass/Fail class
- Prerequisite: none
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): none
- Homework: Scripture memorization
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Material fee: $5